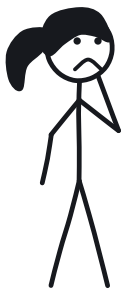
Draw It Yourself

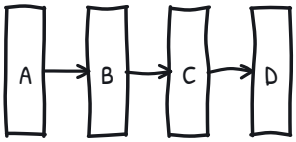
From "Cartooning in Biological Learning" by Soukaina Bahsoun, Mhairi Morris, Elizabeth Akam (2026)

The problem

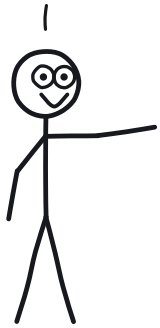
"Complex terms, abstract ideas, steps on steps on steps."

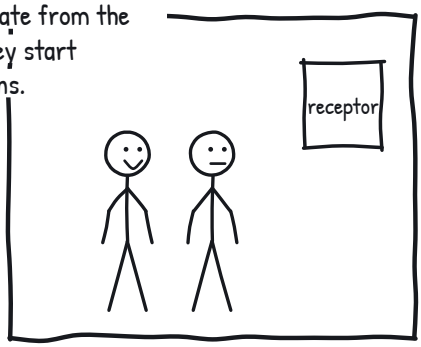


Simplified



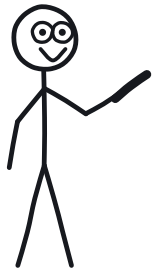
Concept cartoons date from the late 1990s. They start discussions.

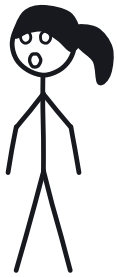


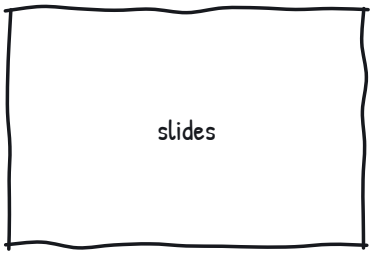


Usually the teacher draws them. What if the students did?



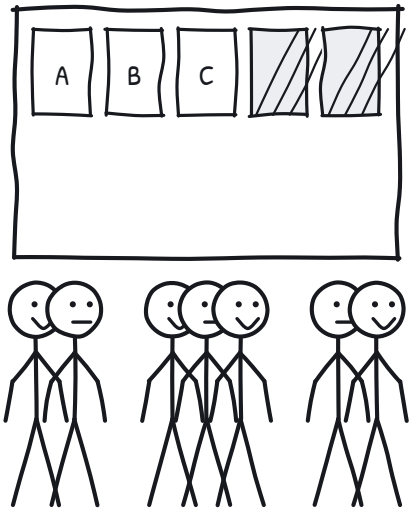




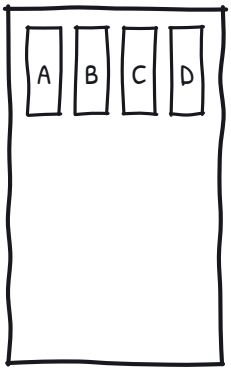


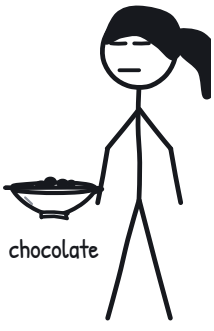
The study

Three modules. 79 students. Teams of 2 to 6. Five subtopics, only three on offer.



A friendly competition. Teams ranked each other's work. The prize was chocolate.



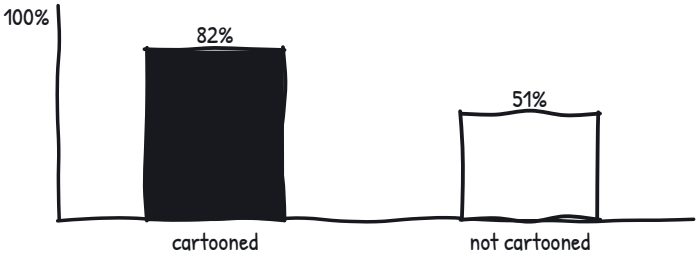


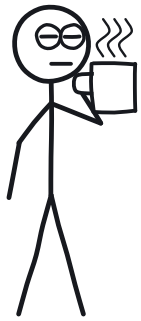
Then a 10-question quiz: 6 questions on cartooned subtopics, 4 on the rest. And an anonymous 18-question survey.



What they found

Quiz median: cartooned 82 percent correct, not cartooned 51.
Significant: p = 0.004.



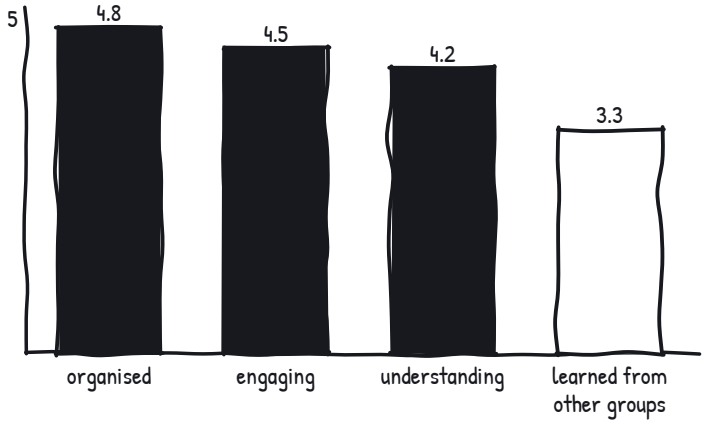


Significant, yes. But that's 20 question averages, not 79 students.



*footnote

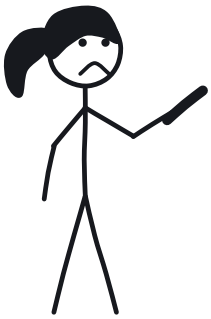
Ratings out of 5: organised 4.8, engaging 4.5, understanding 4.2. Learning from other groups' cartoons: 3.3. 68 percent preferred it to question and answer.

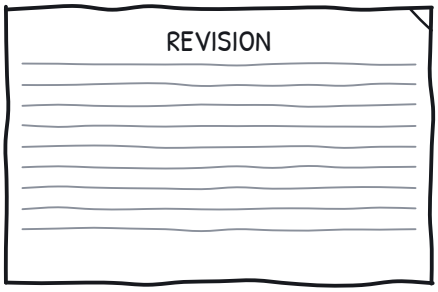


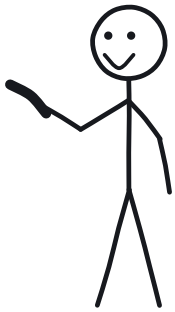
What it means

Would they use it to revise? 44 percent said yes and 20 percent said no. In 120 comments, the themes were learning, engagement, working together, and skills.

Mixed. But I did meet everyone in my group.







Adapted from "Cartooning in Biological Learning" by Soukaina Bahsoun, Mhairi Morris, Elizabeth Akam (2026), doi 10.1002/bmb.70040.
Licence: CC BY 4.0. Condensed into a comic with invented characters and scenes using the science-comic-pipeline; the paper's authors did not write or endorse this document. The pictures are simple cartoons: animals and apparatus are stand-ins and not to scale.
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